strophic threat to regional and global stability. This trend reflects a broader transformation in which power dynamics override established legal norms, undermining the authority and credibility of global institutions tasked with maintaining international peace and security.

Although not direct participants in the ongoing war, the states of the Gulf Cooperation Council occupy a position of vulnerability due to their geographic proximity and strategic significance. As major exporters of oil, natural gas and petrochemical products, their economic stability is closely tied to regional security. These states have consistently warned against escalation. Their refusal to allow their territories to be used for military operations underscores a deliberate policy of neutrality and a clear preference for de-escalation.

PRIORITISING SOVEREIGNTY

Within this broader context, Qatar has maintained a consistent position advocating dialogue and diplomatic engagement as the only viable means of resolving the conflict. From the outset, it has called for restraint and cautioned against actions that could destabilise the region. However, attacks targeting its territory by Israel on September 9, 2025, and Iran's ongoing attacks targeting civilian and energy infrastructure have significantly constrained its capacity to function as a mediator. These developments have necessitated a strategic shift toward prioritising national sovereignty and the protection of its population, while continuing to support diplomatic initiatives aimed at ending this war. Although the attacks by Iran have led to suspension of gas production and exports, Qatar's diplomatic capacity for peace mediation and its soft power influence on the international stage, based on principles of far-sighted strategic vision, remain intact.

Despite the challenges, Qatar has maintained a high level of domestic stability and security. The majority of attacks have been intercepted, allowing for the continuity of daily life and essential services. At the same time, the state has reaffirmed its right under international law to respond to violations of its sovereignty. Nevertheless, the implications of such attacks extend beyond immediate security concerns, as disruptions to energy production and exports pose risks to global markets and challenge Qatar's role as a reliable energy supplier. Furthermore, such disruptions threaten to constrain the country's humanitarian and development assistance programmes, which provide critical support to populations affected by conflict in nations, including Sudan, Syria, Gaza and Afghanistan.

A particularly concerning aspect of the conflict is the deliberate targeting of civilian infrastructure, including power plants, water facilities and critical energy installations. Such actions represent a breach of international norms and carry the risk of long-term economic and environmental consequences.

The risks are further amplified by the possibility of attacks on sensitive or nuclear facilities, which could result in severe environmental damage, including radioactive contamination of the Gulf. These dangers underscore the urgent need for adherence to international law and restraint in military conduct.



DANGER AHEAD A thick plume of smoke rises from the site of an Iranian missile strike in Doha, Mar. 1

AFP

DESPITE THE CHALLENGES, QATAR HAS MAINTAINED DOMESTIC STABILITY. THE MAJORITY OF THE ATTACKS HAVE BEEN INTERCEPTED, ALLOWING DAILY LIFE TO CONTINUE

In response to these violations, Qatar has pursued formal diplomatic channels, including submitting complaints to the United Nations Security Council and engaging directly with the UN secretary-general. These actions reflect a commitment to international law and institutional processes, even as the effectiveness of such mechanisms faces increasing challenges.

The ongoing confrontation between the US, Israel and Iran constitutes a critical test of the resilience of the international system. The weakening of global norms, the vulnerability of essential infrastructure, and the central role of the Gulf region in global energy supply all highlight the far-reaching consequences of continued instability.